Handova

An initiative of **Ethical Bridge**

TRUST & SAFETY · POLICY AND PROCEDURE

Fraud, Bribery and Corruption Policy and Procedure

How we prevent, spot and respond to fraud, bribery, corruption and misuse of Handova.

Version 1.0 | Approved 20 October 2026
Handova, an initiative of Ethical Bridge LLC

Skills handed over.
Capability that stays.

DOCUMENT CONTROL

About this document

DOCUMENT	Handova Fraud, Bribery and Corruption Policy and Procedure
TYPE	Policy and procedure
OWNER	Julieta Castiñeira de Dios
APPROVED BY	Julieta Castiñeira de Dios, founder, for Ethical Bridge LLC
VERSION	1.0
DATE OF APPROVAL	20 October 2026
NEXT REVIEW	October 2027, or sooner when Handova has a team, after a serious incident or when the law changes
APPLIES TO	Professionals, organisations and their staff, and the Handova team
OPERATOR	Handova is an initiative of Ethical Bridge LLC, registered in Wyoming, USA
CONTACT	safeguarding@handova.org · hello@handova.org
LANGUAGE	English

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PROPORTIONATE TO OUR SIZE

Handova is in its early stage. Today one person, Julieta Castiñeira de Dios, the founder, runs both Handova and Ethical Bridge. This is our **first version**: it sets out what we do now and who does it. We will expand it as Handova grows and builds a team. Until then:

- **Julieta Castiñeira de Dios is the safeguarding lead** and Handova's only administrator. She receives reports, decides on protective action and keeps the records described here.
- **An independent contact** handles any concern about the founder, or that the founder is involved in, and covers urgent cases when the founder can't be reached for more than 48 hours. This is a trusted person outside Handova and Ethical Bridge: **to be confirmed soon**. They don't run Handova or investigate alone: they receive the concern, make sure it is handled fairly and get outside help when needed.
- **We review this policy** at least once a year, as soon as Handova has a team, and after any serious incident.

AT A GLANCE

- Handova is free and no money passes between users through it. Anyone who asks for money, fees, gifts or favours in connection with Handova is breaking the rules.
- We have zero tolerance of fraud, bribery and corruption, by anyone, in any form.
- Trust on Handova is never for sale. Approval, the "ID verified" badge, needs review, endorsements and impact CV entries are earned, not bought.
- The main risks are fake or impersonated organisations, fake accounts, invented hours and endorsements, paid-service selling, and misuse of an organisation's systems or data.
- Report any suspicion straight away with **Report a concern** or at safeguarding@handova.org. Do not investigate it yourself.
- We acknowledge every report, preserve evidence, protect those affected, and tell organisations when their systems, data or name are at risk.
- Protective steps, such as suspending an account, are not a finding of guilt.
- Nobody is penalised for reporting honestly.

WHO THIS APPLIES TO

- **The Handova team:** today, Julieta Castiñeira de Dios, the founder and only administrator; in future, anyone with admin access or who reviews profiles, organisations or needs, whether paid, unpaid or a contractor.
- **Volunteers helping Handova itself**, and Ethical Bridge LLC people when they act for Handova.
- **Professionals** using Handova.
- **Organisations** using Handova: the person who signed for it, its members on Handova and its safeguarding focal points.

It covers everything done on or through Handova, including off-platform contact that grew out of a contribution.

PART A

Policy

SECTION 01

Why this matters

Handova works because people trust what they see: that professionals are who they say they are, that organisations are real, locally led non-profits, and that an impact CV entry describes real, reviewed work. Fraud, bribery and corruption break that trust and harm the organisations Handova exists to serve.

SECTION 02

Our position

1. We have zero tolerance of fraud, bribery, corruption and extortion, whether direct or through someone else.
2. Money, gifts, favours or relationships never influence approval, verification, needs review, matching, report decisions or appeals.
3. Everyone covered by this policy helps prevent and report wrongdoing. We check fraud risks before launching any new feature.
4. We respond to every report fairly. Where wrongdoing is confirmed, we act, including against people who knew and did nothing.
5. We tell organisations when their resources or name are affected. We report to the relevant authorities where the law requires it, or where someone is in immediate danger.

Ethical Bridge LLC is registered in Wyoming, USA, and is subject to US federal and Wyoming law. People take part from many countries, so we also follow the law that applies where they are, including the EU and UK GDPR for personal data. Where rules differ, we follow the one that gives people more protection.

Sanctions screening is outside the scope of this policy.

SECTION 03

What we mean

- **Fraud:** deceiving someone to gain something or cause a loss, even if it fails. It includes false identities, false organisation details, invented hours and fabricated endorsements.
- **Bribery:** offering, giving, asking for or accepting any advantage, not only money, so that someone acts improperly in their role.
- **Corruption:** abusing a position of trust for private gain, including favouritism.
- **Extortion:** getting money, work or favours through threats or pressure.
- **Collusion:** people working together to get around the rules.
- **Conflict of interest:** a personal link that could affect, or look as if it affects, a fair decision.

SECTION 04

The risks on Handova and the rules

RISK	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	THE RULE
Fake or impersonated organisations	Pretending to be a real NGO from the Ethical Bridge directory, or inventing one, to get free work, data or credibility.	Only directory-listed, locally led non-profits join, signed for by an authorised person. False organisation details are fraud.
Fake, duplicate or borrowed professional accounts	Running several profiles, using someone else's identity, or letting another person do the work under your name.	One person, one account, true details. You do the work yourself.
Inflated or fabricated hours, endorsements and impact CVs	Logging or approving hours not worked, endorsing work that did not happen, or trading favours for an endorsement, including collusion between an organisation and a professional.	Log and approve hours honestly (maximum 12 a day). Endorsements must be truthful. Inventing or inflating them is fraud and leads to removal.
Asking for money, fees, gifts or favours	A "registration fee", payment to apply or deliver, or a gift or personal favour in return for a need, an invitation, hour approval or an endorsement.	Never ask for or offer any of these. Expenses need separate written terms agreed before anything is spent.

RISK	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	THE RULE
Selling paid services or recruiting for paid work	Using a contribution to sell services or recruit clients, advertising paid jobs, or posting an unpaid job trial as a need.	Unpaid, voluntary contributions only. No selling, advertising or recruitment. If a paid opportunity arises independently, the professional applies through the organisation's normal open process, not through Handova.
Misuse of an organisation's systems, funds or data	Changing bank details, diverting donations, copying data, keeping access after handover, or using the organisation's software for other work.	Use only the access given, only for the agreed work, and hand it back. A professional never receives, holds or moves an organisation's money.
Bribery of or by the Handova team	Offering the team anything to approve an account, speed up review or drop a report; or a team member offering something improper to a funder, official or partner.	The team never asks for, accepts or offers anything to influence a decision. No facilitation payments. Admins don't take part in needs as professionals.
Misuse of the Handova or Ethical Bridge name	Claiming to represent Handova to get money or information.	Only the Handova team speaks for Handova.

SECTION 05

Gifts and hospitality

No gifts, hospitality, payments or favours connected to a Handova contribution, for anyone. Professionals do not ask for or accept them, organisations do not offer them, and the Handova team neither gives nor accepts them. A thank-you and an honest endorsement are the thanks.

SECTION 06

Conflicts of interest

- **Team:** declare in writing any personal, family, financial or professional link to an organisation or professional before deciding anything about them, and step aside. While the founder is the only administrator, those decisions go to the independent contact (**to be confirmed soon**). The founder also makes a written declaration each year.
- **Professionals and organisations:** a conflict of interest is allowed only with a written declaration to Handova and Handova's agreement on how it is managed. A professional may not endorse, or be endorsed by, an organisation they lead, work for or have a close family link to.

SECTION 07

How we prevent fraud

- **Organisations:** before approval, Handova checks the organisation's Ethical Bridge directory page and confirms the signatory's authority, for example by a reply from the directory contact or an email at the organisation's own domain.
- **Professionals:** every profile is reviewed before it is public, and identity is verified with Didit before signing a contribution agreement. We check for duplicate accounts. Handova may ask for a reference or a short video call before approving a profile.
- **Needs:** reviewed before they open. We reject any that charges a fee, offers payment, advertises, recruits, replaces a paid role or asks a professional to handle money.
- **Contributions:** signed agreement before work; hours capped at 12 a day and by the 16-hour need, and approved by the organisation; endorsements correctable once; a six-month check on whether the work is still in use. Messages stay on Handova and cannot be edited or deleted.
- **Signals we watch:** hours well above the estimate, many maximum-hour days, completion very soon after signing, the same device or network on both signatures, and repeated endorsements between the same people.
- **For the future:** as Handova grows, we will add training for the team and short briefings for professionals and organisations.

PART B

Procedure

SECTION 08

How to report

Report as soon as you suspect something:

- **Report a concern** on any profile, need, conversation or contribution (signed-in users), choosing "Fraud, payment requests or false hours";
- email **safeguarding@handova.org** (anyone, signed in or not);
- if the concern is about the founder, write to the independent contact (**to be confirmed soon**), as set out in the Whistleblowing Policy and Procedure.

You can write in English, Spanish, Portuguese or French. If you want to stay anonymous, write from an email address that doesn't identify you. Say what happened, when, who or which page it concerns, and how you know. Keep evidence you already have, such as screenshots of messages sent outside Handova, but do not collect more, confront anyone or discuss it with others. If you suspect misuse of a system someone can access, remove their access and change passwords first.

SECTION 09

What happens after a report

Today Julieta Castiñeira de Dios handles every report herself. If a report is about her, or she has a conflict, the independent contact (**to be confirmed soon**) handles it instead. She:

1. **Acknowledges it.** Reports made on the platform get an automatic acknowledgement with a reference. Emailed reports are acknowledged within 2 working days, the same day if someone may be at risk.
2. **Assesses it** within 2 working days, the same day if it is urgent. If it also raises a safeguarding concern, the Safeguarding Policy and Procedure applies as well.

LEVEL	EXAMPLES	FIRST ACTION
Urgent	Live access to an organisation's systems or funds, active impersonation of a real NGO, someone being pressured for money	Protective action within 24 hours
Serious	Fake or duplicate account, fabricated hours or endorsements, paid-service selling	Look into it, aiming to finish within 30 days
Low	A misunderstanding about expenses, a single inaccurate hour entry	Clarify and correct with the people involved

3. **Preserves evidence.** Messages cannot be edited or deleted, and once a conversation or contribution is reported, she can read it. Signature records (signed text, hash, time, IP address and browser), logged hours, approvals, endorsements and correction history stay with the contribution record. When a case opens, she saves a dated copy of anything that could change or be deleted, such as a public profile or messages, and if identity fraud is suspected she asks Didit to review the identity-check session before it expires (Didit keeps sessions for up to one year).
4. **Protects people and evidence.** Depending on the risk, she may suspend a person or organisation, freeze a conversation, take down a need, hide a profile or close a contribution. These steps are not a finding of guilt. She reviews them at least every 14 days and lifts them when they are no longer needed.
5. **Looks into it.** She tells the person concerned about the allegation when this will not put evidence or anyone at risk, and gives them a fair chance to respond. She may ask the other party, or the organisation's safeguarding focal point, for information. She decides on the balance of probabilities and records the reasons. For serious or complex cases, Handova may bring in an external adviser or investigator. If the authorities are investigating, we cooperate and do not get in their way.
6. **Tells the organisation.** If a professional may have misused an organisation's systems, funds or data, she tells the organisation straight away so it can remove access, change passwords and check payments. If someone has impersonated a real NGO, she tells it through its Ethical Bridge directory contact. If an organisation is under suspicion, she tells professionals working with it only what they need to protect themselves.
7. **Reports to the authorities** where the law requires it, or where someone is in immediate danger, and records the reasons. We encourage an affected organisation to report to its own local authorities,

support it with our records, and respond to lawful requests from authorities.

8. **Decides the outcome.** If wrongdoing is confirmed, she may remove the person or organisation and prevent them from returning, or remove or correct affected hours, endorsements and impact CV entries, and tells those affected. Where Handova restricts or removes an account or content, we tell the person why and how to ask for a review. Anyone removed can ask for a review within 30 days by writing to the independent contact (**to be confirmed soon**).

We will expand this procedure as Handova grows.

SECTION 10

Confidentiality and protection

Reports are confidential and shared only on a need-to-know basis. We do not reveal the reporter's identity without consent, unless the law requires it. We never put personal, confidential, report, identity or safeguarding information into AI tools. Retaliating against anyone who reports or helps with a case is a serious breach, as is knowingly making a false report. Legal protection for whistleblowers depends on where you are and your relationship with Handova; this policy protects you on Handova regardless. See the Whistleblowing Policy and Procedure.

SECTION 11

Records

The founder keeps a confidential case register: reference, date, people and pages involved, triage level, protective actions, who was informed, referral decisions, outcome, reasons and lessons. Only the safeguarding lead can see it, and the independent contact for cases about the founder. Case records are kept for 6 years after the case closes, or longer if legal proceedings are ongoing or expected; cases involving a child are kept until the child turns 25 or for 6 years after closure, whichever is later. Then they are deleted. The register is reviewed once a year. Personal data is handled under the Handova Data Protection Policy and privacy notice.

SECTION 12

Review and related documents

The founder reviews this document every year, and after any serious case, using lessons from the case register. She also writes a short anonymised yearly summary of concerns, outcomes and lessons, kept on file and shared with the independent contact once named.

Related: Handova Safeguarding Policy and Procedure; Anti-Harassment, Intimidation and Bullying Policy and Procedure; Code of Conduct; Data Protection Policy; Whistleblowing Policy and Procedure; Independent Contact Role Note; professional, organisation and contribution agreements; terms of use; privacy notice.

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